

gourd vase, the wall vase, the porcelain hook, the porcelain plume-tube, the *Ruyi*, the floral *Xun*, the hat rack, the small bag and so on.

The rule of pattern was proper, steady and natural, and the life painting was flourishing but not out of orders, terse and fine. The painting had the hundreds of birds singing, the plants in blossom, the deep and secluded mountain valleys and streams, the refined scholars and warriors, the immortals, children at play, the Western women and so on, all of which were made with adroit skills. In decorative method, they learned widely from others' strong points and their skills exceeded the nature after painstaking efforts, presenting a glorious and marvellous spectacle, which was incomparable in any times before. The huge vase in glaze colours that was called *Cimu* (Mother Porcelain) was the representative type of this time. The vase was as high as 86 cm, erudite and robust, with the double *Chi*-dragon-shaped handles attached to the neck; and the vase was painted with 14 kinds of colour glazes including the *Qinghua*, the enamel, the *Fencai*, the five-colours, the contrasting colours, the celadon glaze, the red glaze, the blue glaze, the photochromic glaze, the Ge glaze, the Guan glaze, the turquoise green glaze, the caramel glaze, and the gold colour, as well as the overglaze colours and the underglaze colours. The formula, the firing atmosphere and demands of these glazes and colours were different, but they all achieved the best effect on the vase. There were 15 circles of patterns transversely and 12 panels vertically on the vase bodies. There were some main themes related to auspiciousness: "*San Yang Kai Tai* (the opening of nature in spring)," "*Ji Qing You Yu* (wealth and joy)," "*Dan Feng Chao Yang* (the phoenix makes a bow to the sun)," "*Tai Ping You Xiang* (omen for peace and tranquillity)," and the immortal lingzhi and so on, resorting to every conceivable means for decoration. It could be called having assembled a galaxy of Jingdezhen porcelain craftsmanship and porcelain arts of all times.

Compared with the magnificence and nobility in Kangxi Reign and with the gracefulness and prettiness in Yongzheng Reign, the porcelain products made in Qianlong Reign were gorgeous and extremely exquisite, forming its style of the time -- ***the beauty of extreme gorgeousness***.

Taken a whole view of the porcelain art of three reigns of Kangxi, Yongzheng and Qianlong, the evolution of the style was closely linked with the politics, economy and culture of the times and the cultivation and interest of the emperors. During Kangxi Reign, the feudal empire was thriving and prosperous, therefore, this was the milestone-like artistic creation and the pioneering achievement

in varieties of porcelains. The trend of the times surged forwards and gradually flowed into Yongzheng Reign, turning the vigorousness and firmness to gentleness. By Qianlong Reign, a time of national peace and order, there emerged the gorgeousness like sunglow, but as a Tang poet put it, "the setting sun was wonderful here was approaching the dusk."